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THE KING'S LODGE

Discovering the Psalms

By Phil Leage

Part 9

Royal and Messianic Psalms

Other Categories of Psalm

- Wisdom Psalms
- Songs of Trust
- Liturgies
- Coronation Psalms
- Songs of Zion
- Etc.

Royal and Messianic Psalms

Royal Psalms

- These are psalms by, for, about or to the king
- The king plays a central role
- Included in many categories of Psalms

Messianic Psalms

- These royal psalms seem to point beyond the king to the Messiah
- Parts of these palms are quoted in the New Testament concerning Jesus

Example: Psalm 118:22-23

22 The stone that the builders rejected
has become the chief cornerstone.
23 This is the Lord ’s doing;
it is marvellous in our eyes

Psalm 118:22-23

- These verses are quoted five times in the New Testament
- Each time speaking of Jesus
- Matt 21:42, Mark 12:10 - 11,
- Luke 20:17, Acts 4:11 and 1 Peter 2:7

Example: Matt 21:42 Parable of the Wicked Tenants

[42]Jesus said to them, “Have you never read in the scriptures:
‘The stone that the builders rejected
has become the cornerstone;
this was the Lord’s doing,
and it is amazing in our eyes’

Example: Psalm 118:25-26

[25]Save us, we beseech you, O Lord!

O Lord, we beseech you, give us success!

[26]Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord.

We bless you from the house of the Lord

Psalm 118:25-26

- These verses are quoted five times in the New Testament
- Each time speaking about Jesus
- Matt 21:9, Mark 11:9
- Luke 13:35, 19:38 and John 12:13

Example: Matt 21:9 Jesus' Triumphal Entry into Jerusalem

9 The crowds that went ahead of him and that followed were shouting,
"Hosanna to the Son of David!
Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord!
Hosanna in the highest heaven

Understanding ‘Messianic’ in the Narrow Sense

- These Psalms are prophetic, there is no direct message for the Old Testament time

Understanding ‘Messianic’ in the Narrow Sense

- They only predict the coming Messiah
- Psalm 110 is the best example
- Matt 22:44, Mk 12:36, Heb 1:13

Example: Psalm 110:1

[1]The Lord says to my lord,
“Sit at my right hand
until I make your enemies your footstool

Example Matt 22:43-45, Jesus Challenging the Pharisees

43 He said to them, “How is it then that David
by the Spirit calls him Lord, saying,
44 ‘The Lord said to my Lord,
“Sit at my right hand,
until I put your enemies under your feet” ’?
45 If David thus calls him Lord, how can he
be his son

Problem with this Narrow Sense

- What do we do with the parts of the Psalm that could not apply to the Messiah?

Psalm 69 is quoted 9 times with regard to the Messiah

- v9 - John 2:17, Rom 15:3
- v4 - John 15:25
- v21 - Matt 27:34, Mk 15:36, Luke 23:36, John 19:29
- v22 - Rom 11:9-10
- v24 - Rev 16:1

Psalm 69 Narrowly Messianic?

- What about v 5
- 5 O God, you know my folly;
- the wrongs I have done are not hidden from you.

Psalm 69 Narrowly Messianic?

- What about the imprecatory verses in 22ff
- 22Let their table be a trap for them,
- a snare for their allies.
- 23Let their eyes be darkened so that they cannot see,
- and make their loins tremble continually.
- 24Pour out your indignation upon them,
- and let your burning anger overtake them.
- 25May their camp be a desolation;
- let no one live in their tents…

Psalm 16 v10

- [10]For you do not give me up to Sheol,

  or let your faithful one see the Pit
- Read as a messianic psalm in narrow sense

Psalm 16 v10

- This is because of Acts 13:32-39
- Paul - “this psalm could not refer to David”

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Psalm 16 v 10 cont'd

- Peter used this Psalm in Acts 2:25-28
- Peter says it's prophesying the resurrection.

Problem with Narrow Sense

- What do we do with the rest of Psalm 16
- It is about trust in the midst of a crisis of illness

Problem with Narrow Sense

- What do we do with Psalm 118:18
- 18The Lord has punished me severely,

  but he did not give me over to death

Understanding ‘Messianic’ in the Broader Sense

- Messianic in the general sense
- Royal Psalms can anticipates the Messiah

Understanding ‘Messianic’ in the Broader Sense

- Thus Psalm 110 was talking about a King of Israel’s Coronation
- But there was a fuller and more complete fulfilment in the enthronement of Jesus

Understanding ‘Messianic’ in the Broader Sense

- Psalm 16 is about a King desiring to not die but to be healed from sickness
- But there was a fuller and more complete fulfilment in Jesus who did die, but death could not hold him

Understanding ‘Messianic’ in the Broader Sense

- Psalm 69 is about a King in great trouble
- But there was a fuller and more complete fulfilment in Jesus who would know victory over all of his enemies

Understanding Kingship in Israel

- In 1 Sam 8 - monarchy set in motion
- In 1 Sam 11:14-12:25 - covenant renewal ceremony

Understanding Kingship in Israel

- The human king should not infringe on the heavenly King
- The human king was but an earthly representative of God the true King of Israel

Understanding Kingship in Israel

- The Israelite king was to be a human reflection of the Kingship of God
- Jesus is the fulfilment of the promise to David – As Jesus was fulfilment of promise to Abraham

Understanding Kingship in Israel

- David is a shadow of the Messiah - As the high priest is the shadow of Jesus the High Priest
- David does not emerge faultless - Neither does Abraham or Aaron

Derek Kidner:

- "…but as the perfect kingdom is foreshadowed by a limited and imperfect one, so the perfect Man is typified by a sinner whose sufferings, faith, sovereignty and sonship He utterly transcends"